IDENTITY EXPLORATION

THE GATHERING PLACE

SIX MARK DIRECTIONS

March 2026 · Confidential · Document 001

THE BRIEF

You spent twenty years filling rooms.
This is the one place where nobody has to.

Drew Dudley has given over 1,000 keynote speeches. He has stood on stages in front of thousands of people and made them feel something. He is very good at it. And after twenty years of it, he had one question: *what would it look like to spend a year sitting around a fire with people I find genuinely interesting — and just let it be that?*

The Gathering Place is the answer. A private membership — eight to twelve founding members — rotating between high-end properties in Toronto, the Kawarthas, and Barbados. A professional studio. A home for people who have been "on" long enough to deserve somewhere to be off. The founding tension is everything: *exclusive without being cold. Warm without being casual. Private without being secretive.*

DESIGN CRITERIA · EACH MARK WAS EVALUATED AGAINST FIVE TESTS

01 **Legible at two extremes**
Works at 16px on a phone screen and at 16 feet on a building façade.

02 **No literal translation**
The mark suggests — it does not explain. It rewards a second look.

03 **Dual reading**
Every finalist holds more than one meaning. The second meaning is the real one.

04 **Timeless construction**
No gradients, no drop shadows, no trends. Would look as right in 1976 as in 2026.

05 **The reversal test**
Works gold on charcoal and charcoal on cream. Identity that only works in one colorway is fragile.

PRIMARY READING
A flame

SECONDARY READING
Three people leaning toward each other

The Hearthstone

The moment a conversation becomes real, everyone leans in.

THE STRATEGY

Every great gathering begins with one gesture. Not an introduction, not a handshake — a lean. The almost imperceptible shift forward that says: I am here, I am listening, this matters. The Hearthstone captures that moment in its most reduced, most essential form.

Three arcs share a single base point. Your eye reads them simultaneously as a flame and as three figures in conversation, and it cannot choose between the two meanings — because both are true. That is not a trick of design. It is the thing itself. The Gathering Place is a fire, and it is the people around it, and neither exists without the other.

The mark is built with geometric precision: equal arcs, equal weight, one shared origin. Nothing is decorative. Nothing is incidental. The convergence at the base is the gathering — the point where separate paths become one warmth. The arcs that spread above it are what happens next: possibility, movement, the thing that only exists because people chose to be in the same room.

This is the mark we would build everything else from.

COLOR SYSTEM

Primary · Gold on Charcoal

Reversed · Charcoal on Cream

Foil · Gold on Cream

Monochrome · White on Charcoal

APPLICATIONS

DREW DUDLEY
Founder · The Gathering Place

THE GATHERING PLACE
A Private Creative Membership

FOUNDING MEMBER
[Member Name]
TGP · 001

SCALE

512 256 128 64 32

PRIMARY READING
Open arms held wide

SECONDARY READING
A sacred space being protected

The Embrace

There is a space between open arms and a closed circle. The Gathering Place lives in that gap.

THE STRATEGY

The Embrace does something most logos refuse to do: it places the most important element in empty space. Two arcs curve toward each other from opposite sides of the composition, nearly completing a circle — but not quite. The gap at the top is deliberate. It is the entrance.

That gap is the entire philosophy of The Gathering Place. The space is not closed off. It is curated. The arms are open, but not to everyone — to the right people, at the right moment, when the conditions are right for something real to happen. The bright point at center is what they are holding: the warmth, the idea, the conversation that could only happen here.

What makes this mark unusual is its confidence. Most marks announce themselves. The Embrace makes a quieter claim: that what matters is not the mark itself, but what it surrounds. Drew didn't build The Gathering Place to be known. He built it so that certain things could happen inside it. This mark understands that.

COLOR SYSTEM

Primary · Gold on Charcoal

Reversed · Charcoal on Cream

Foil · Gold on Cream

Monochrome · White on Charcoal

APPLICATIONS

DREW DUDLEY
Founder · The Gathering Place

THE GATHERING PLACE
A Private Creative Membership

FOUNDING MEMBER
[Member Name]
TGP · 002

SCALE

512 256 128 64 32

PRIMARY READING
A chalice or cup

SECONDARY READING
Cupped hands offered upward

The Vessel

Before anything can be poured out, something must be willing to hold it.

THE STRATEGY

To gather is, at its most fundamental, to hold. The Vessel makes this explicit. Two arcs meet at a pointed base and open upward — the universal form of offering. It is a cup, and it is hands held open, and the distinction doesn't matter because they mean the same thing.

There is something old about this mark. The chalice form appears across cultures and centuries because it answers a universal question: where does the good thing go? The Gathering Place is a vessel. It holds the conversations that don't happen at conferences, the ideas that need a room without an agenda, the rest that high-performing people have earned and rarely take. The mark says: here is the container. What you pour into it is yours.

The construction is as minimal as a mark can be. Two lines. One convergence. The interior space — all that charcoal darkness above — is not emptiness. It is capacity.

COLOR SYSTEM

Primary · Gold on Charcoal

Reversed · Charcoal on Cream

Foil · Gold on Cream

Monochrome · White on Charcoal

APPLICATIONS

DREW DUDLEY
Founder · The Gathering Place

THE GATHERING PLACE
A Private Creative Membership

FOUNDING MEMBER
[Member Name]
TGP · 003

SCALE

512 256 128 64 32

PRIMARY READING
Two flames spreading outward

SECONDARY READING
Open wings, or an open book

The Double Flame

Two fires burn better than one — not because they share warmth, but because each reflects the other.

THE STRATEGY

Where the Hearthstone converges, the Double Flame expands. Two arcs mirror each other from a shared base point — a single bright center — their tops spreading outward and away, like flames finding their own air, like wings opening, like two people who came into a room separately and are leaving changed.

The mark speaks to what happens at The Gathering Place at its best: people arrive as one version of themselves and discover, through conversation, something they hadn't seen before. Not transformation. Revelation. The expansion is already in them. The space gives it somewhere to go.

There is a reading here about the relationship between Drew and his members. He is not the teacher. The Gathering Place is not a curriculum. It is the shared point at the base — the reason two different trajectories end up in the same room. What radiates outward is entirely theirs. The mark is honest about that.

COLOR SYSTEM

Primary · Gold on Charcoal

Reversed · Charcoal on Cream

Foil · Gold on Cream

Monochrome · White on Charcoal

APPLICATIONS

DREW DUDLEY
Founder · The Gathering Place

THE GATHERING PLACE
A Private Creative Membership

FOUNDING MEMBER
[Member Name]
TGP · 004

SCALE

512 256 128 64 32

PRIMARY READING
Roots spreading from a shared trunk

SECONDARY READING
Light hanging from above, or rain from a single cloud

The Inverted Hearthstone

The root is not the less glamorous part of the tree. It is the part that makes everything else possible.

THE STRATEGY

The Hearthstone gathers upward — flame, aspiration, the lean-in. Its inversion answers a different question: what holds it all up?

Three arcs share a point at the top and spread downward — like roots beneath a tree, like a lantern hanging from a beam, like the quiet infrastructure of a great gathering that no one sees because it is working perfectly. The Inverted Hearthstone is the mark for people who understand that the most important things in a room are rarely the most visible.

Drew has spent twenty years above the waterline. The Gathering Place is a deliberate act of going under — building the thing that sustains rather than the thing that performs. This mark is for people who have done enough visible work to want, finally, to do the invisible kind. The kind that lasts. The kind that holds.

COLOR SYSTEM

Primary · Gold on Charcoal

Reversed · Charcoal on Cream

Foil · Gold on Cream

Monochrome · White on Charcoal

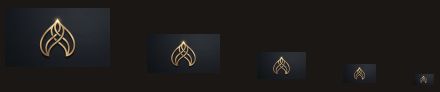
APPLICATIONS

DREW DUDLEY
Founder · The Gathering Place

THE GATHERING PLACE
A Private Creative Membership

FOUNDING MEMBER
[Member Name]
TGP · 005

SCALE



512 256 128 64 32

PRIMARY READING
A seedling emerging from soil

SECONDARY READING
A candle flame on a stem — or a new idea

The Seedling

Every institution that lasts began as one small, brave thing.

THE STRATEGY

The Seedling is the most audacious of the six marks, because it asks the most of the viewer. A single arc forms a stem. At its tip: a small teardrop. That is the entire mark. There is nothing else.

In a category where identity systems compete for complexity and craft, the Seedling refuses to compete at all. It is the visual equivalent of Drew's quietest room principle: if you want to be heard, stop filling the air. The mark earns attention by not demanding it.

But look longer. The seedling form is one of the oldest hopeful symbols in human experience — it is the thing that will become the tree, the institution, the place people return to for decades. The Gathering Place is eight months old. The founding cohort is not yet full. This is the mark for a place that knows what it will become and is patient enough to start as a single, brave curve on a dark ground.

It will be the hardest mark to use confidently. It will also be the one no one forgets.

COLOR SYSTEM

Primary · Gold on Charcoal

Reversed · Charcoal on Cream

Foil · Gold on Cream

Monochrome · White on Charcoal

APPLICATIONS

DREW DUDLEY
Founder · The Gathering Place

THE GATHERING PLACE
A Private Creative Membership

FOUNDING MEMBER
[Member Name]
TGP · 006

SCALE

512 256 128 64 32

THE SIX MARKS · COMPARATIVE VIEW

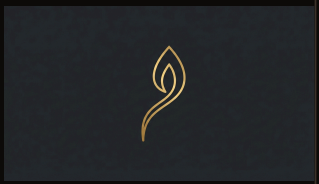
The Hearthstone

The Embrace

The Vessel

The Double Flame

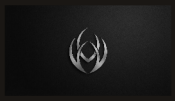
The Inverted Hearthstone



The Seedling

GRAYSCALE · THE STRENGTH TEST

"A mark that works in one color works in all of them."



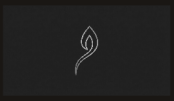
Hearthstone

Embrace

Vessel

Double Flame

Inverted Hearthstone



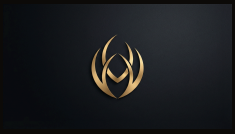
Seedling

PERSONALITY MATRIX

Each mark occupies a distinct position in the brand's personality space. This is useful not just for choosing a mark — but for understanding what character The Gathering Place wants to project and to whom. No quadrant is wrong. They are different truths about the same space.

- The Hearthstone
- The Embrace
- The Vessel
- The Double Flame
- The Inverted Hearthstone
- The Seedling

OUR RECOMMENDATION



The Hearthstone

"The moment a conversation becomes real, everyone leans in."

If we were making this decision, it would be The Hearthstone — not because it is the most beautiful, but because it is the most true. The mark does something almost impossible: it holds two meanings in the same breath, and neither reading cancels the other. A flame. Three people leaning in. The Gathering Place is both of those things simultaneously, and so is this mark.

It will also be the most useful. It scales cleanly to 16px. It works embossed on cream stock. It works engraved in brass on a door. It works as a wax seal. It works reversed. Every practical test a mark can face, this one passes.

IF YOU WANT SOMETHING DIFFERENT

The Embrace	The mark for a brand that leads with welcome. Warmer than the Hearthstone. More explicit about inclusion.
The Vessel	The mark for a brand that positions itself around holding space. Ancient in feeling. Contemplative.
The Double Flame	The mark for a brand that emphasises what members take away. Expansive. Forward-facing.
The Inverted Hearthstone	The mark for a brand that wants to emphasise groundedness and foundation. Quietest of the six.
The Seedling	The mark for a brand that wants to signal its own becoming. Boldest choice. Highest risk, highest reward.

WHAT COMES NEXT

Phase 2	Finalize mark selection. Develop the full identity system: sub-marks, motion language, type guide, spatial rules.
Phase 3	Production files. SVG master, EPS, PNG at all resolutions. Pantone + CMYK specifications for print.
Phase 4	Brand guidelines. The document you hand to web developers, printers, event vendors, and photographers.

THE GATHERING PLACE

Identity Exploration · 2026 · Confidential